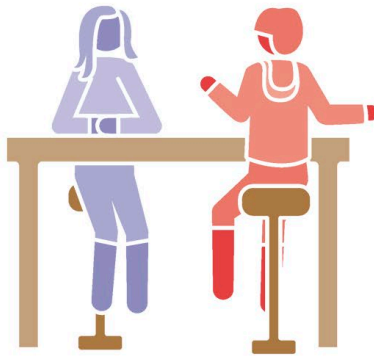


Listening

Good communication requires both sides to listen well and to speak well. To listen well is to think about what the other person is saying and show attentiveness through nodding, making listening noises like “uh-huh,” and asking questions about what’s been said. This can be especially difficult if a person is nervous and thinking about what they are going to say next instead of actually listening.

▷ Active listening

Being still, sitting face-to-face, and displaying positive body language show that a person is fully engaged and listening.



TEEN HINTS

Effective communication

Good communication can be learned and developed.

- Maintaining eye contact shows interest in what the other person is saying, and confidence in yourself.
- Asking the other person's opinion shows attentiveness to the conversation and draws the other person into revealing more.
- Mirroring the other person's body language and tone suggests a connection and builds rapport.

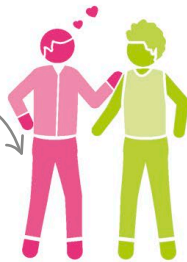
Nonverbal communication skills

Sometimes, a person doesn't even need to speak for a message to be conveyed loud and clear. At other times, the things we write (such as in text messages or on social media) may not be understood as the person who wrote it intended. This is usually because facial expressions and tone of voice, which would be clear face-to-face, are not part of the message. Body posture, facial expressions, and hand movement all add to what is being said—as well as giving clues to feelings a person might prefer to keep to themselves.

▽ Reading body language

Paying attention to body language will give silent clues as to how a person is feeling in any given moment.

When one person is attracted to another, they may lock their gaze on them, stand near them, or silently try to catch their attention.



An interested person will face the person talking, and may react with their facial expressions as they listen.

An annoyed person may seek to look away or avoid the eye contact of the person who annoyed them.

An angry person may flare their nostrils and sometimes even make a fist with their hands.



Smiling, laughing, and matching the posture of others are signs of friendly body language.



A bored person may roll their eyes, look away, or fidget.



An embarrassed person may smile weakly, grimace, or fidget.